

TOPIC 3: THE VISIT OF THE WISE MEN

1. The Account (Matthew 2:1–12)

Wise men (Magi) from the East saw a star and came to Jerusalem seeking the newborn King of the Jews. Herod was troubled and asked the chief priests where the Christ was to be born; they answered Bethlehem. Herod secretly asked the Magi to report back. Guided by the star, they found the child with Mary, worshipped Him and offered gifts of gold, frankincense and myrrh. Warned in a dream not to return to Herod, they went home another way.

2. Meaning of the Gifts

- **Gold** – symbol of kingship
- **Frankincense** – used in worship; points to divinity
- **Myrrh** – used in burial; points to suffering and death

3. Lessons

- Jesus is King for all nations (Gentiles also came to worship).
- True wisdom seeks and worships Christ.
- God protects His purposes (warning dream).
- We should offer our best to Jesus.

4. Summary

The visit of the wise men shows that Jesus is recognised as King by people from far away. Their gifts and worship point to His kingship, divinity and future sacrifice.

End of Topic 3